Tuning of a Babylonian harp

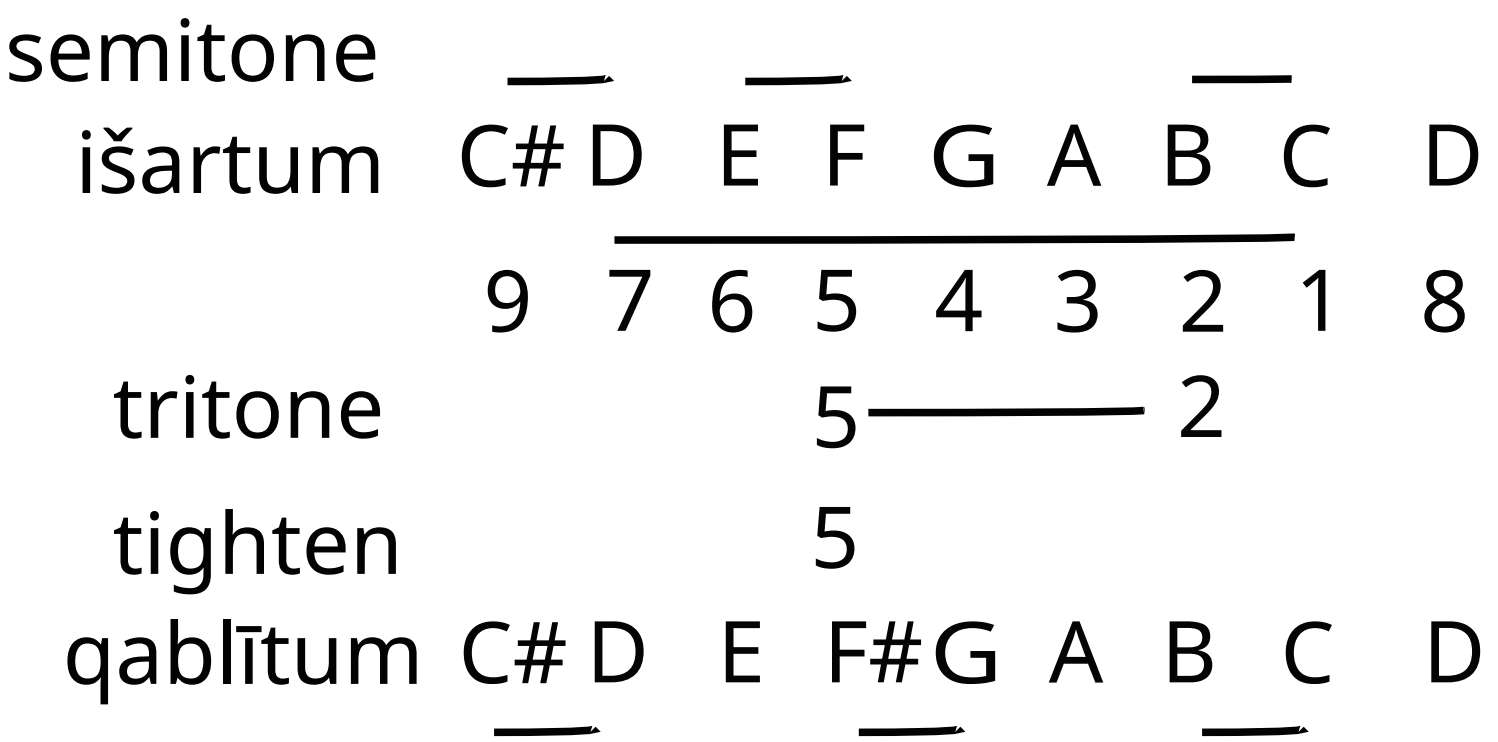
If the harp is išartum

the 'unclear interval' between strings 5 and 2 is qablītum

tighten by a 'semi-tone' string 5

the harp will be qablītum

Dumbrill R. The Truth about Babylonian Music. ICONEA PUBLICATIONS.



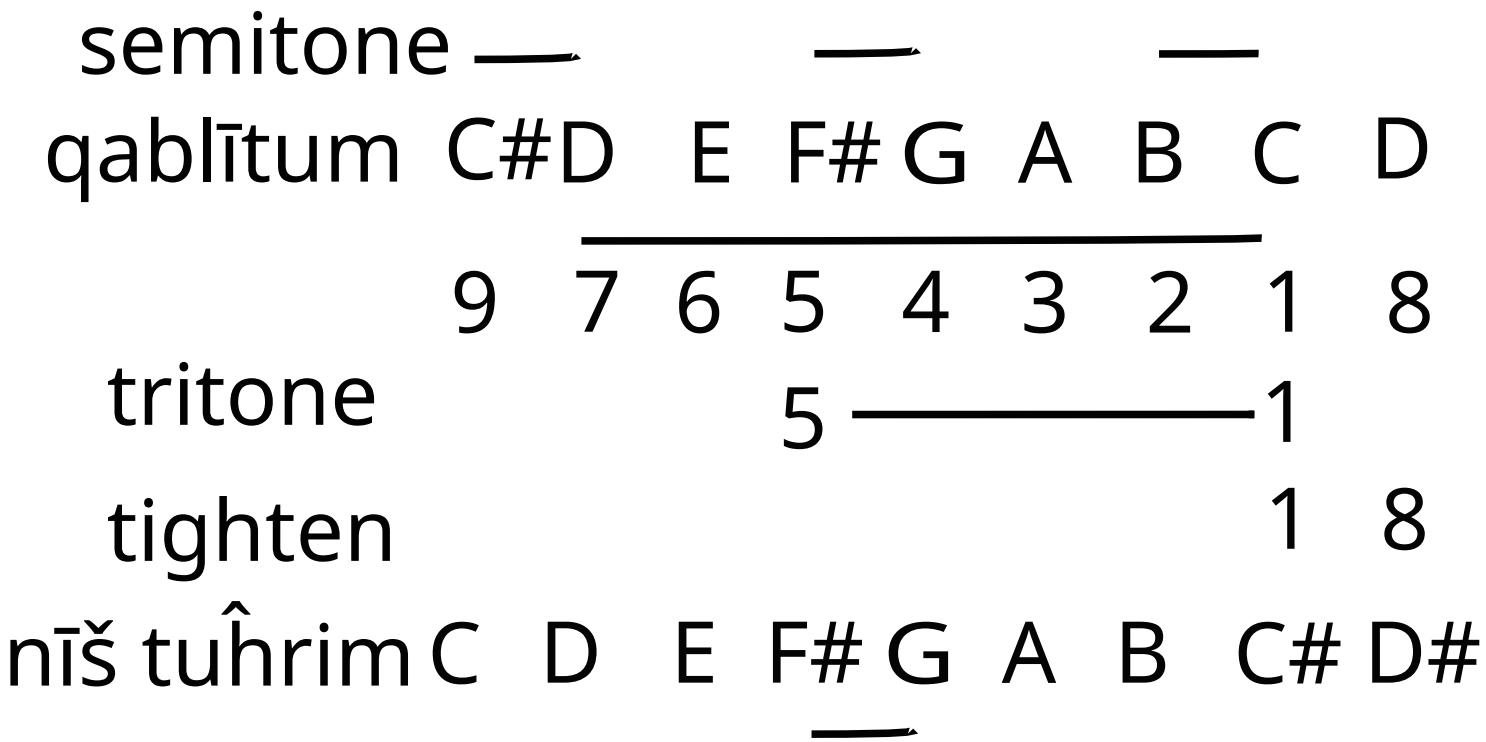
Tuning of a Babylonian harp 2

If the harp is qablītum

the 'unclear interval' between strings 1 and 5 is nīš tuḪrim

tighten strings 1 and 8 (missing: lower 9)

the harp will be nīš tuḪrim



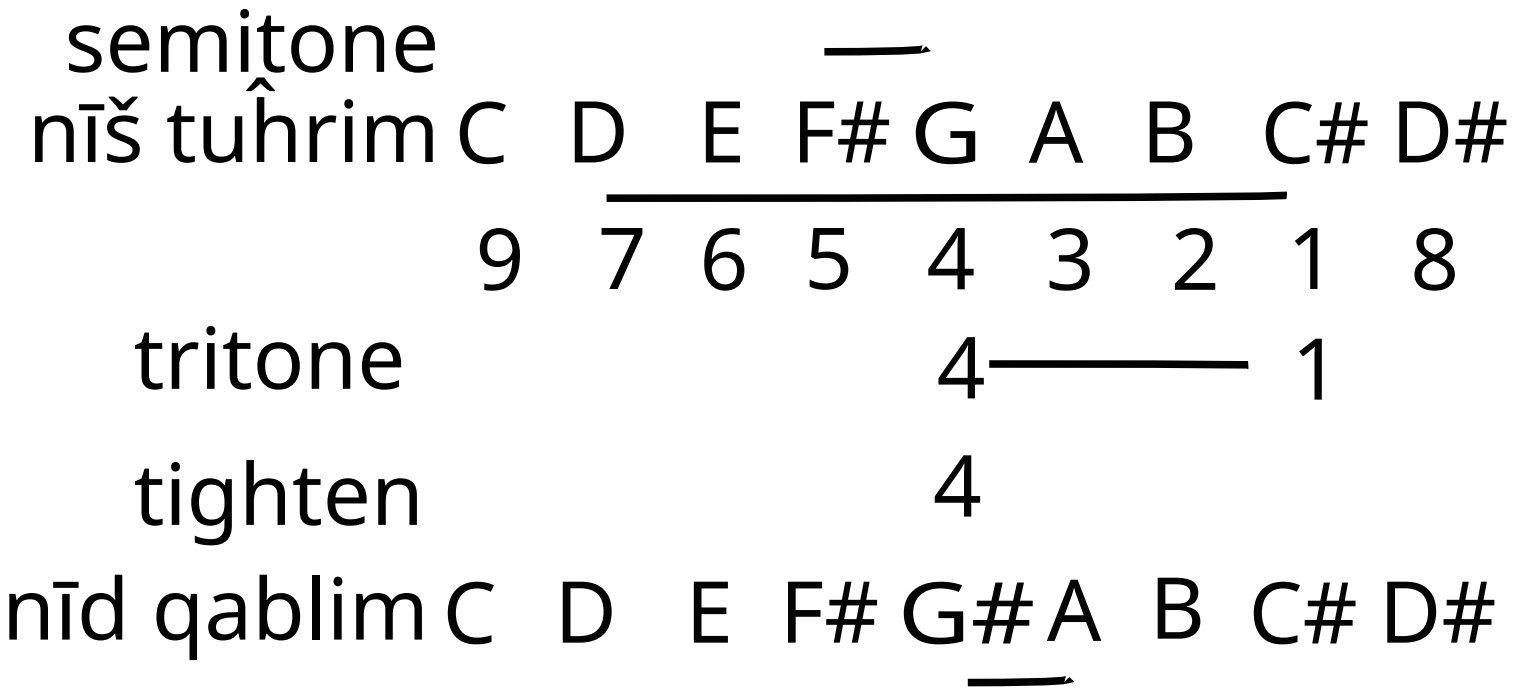
Tuning of a Babylonian harp 3

If the harp is nīš tuĤrim

the 'unclear interval' between strings 4 and 1 is nīd qablim

tighten string 4

the harp will be nīd qablim



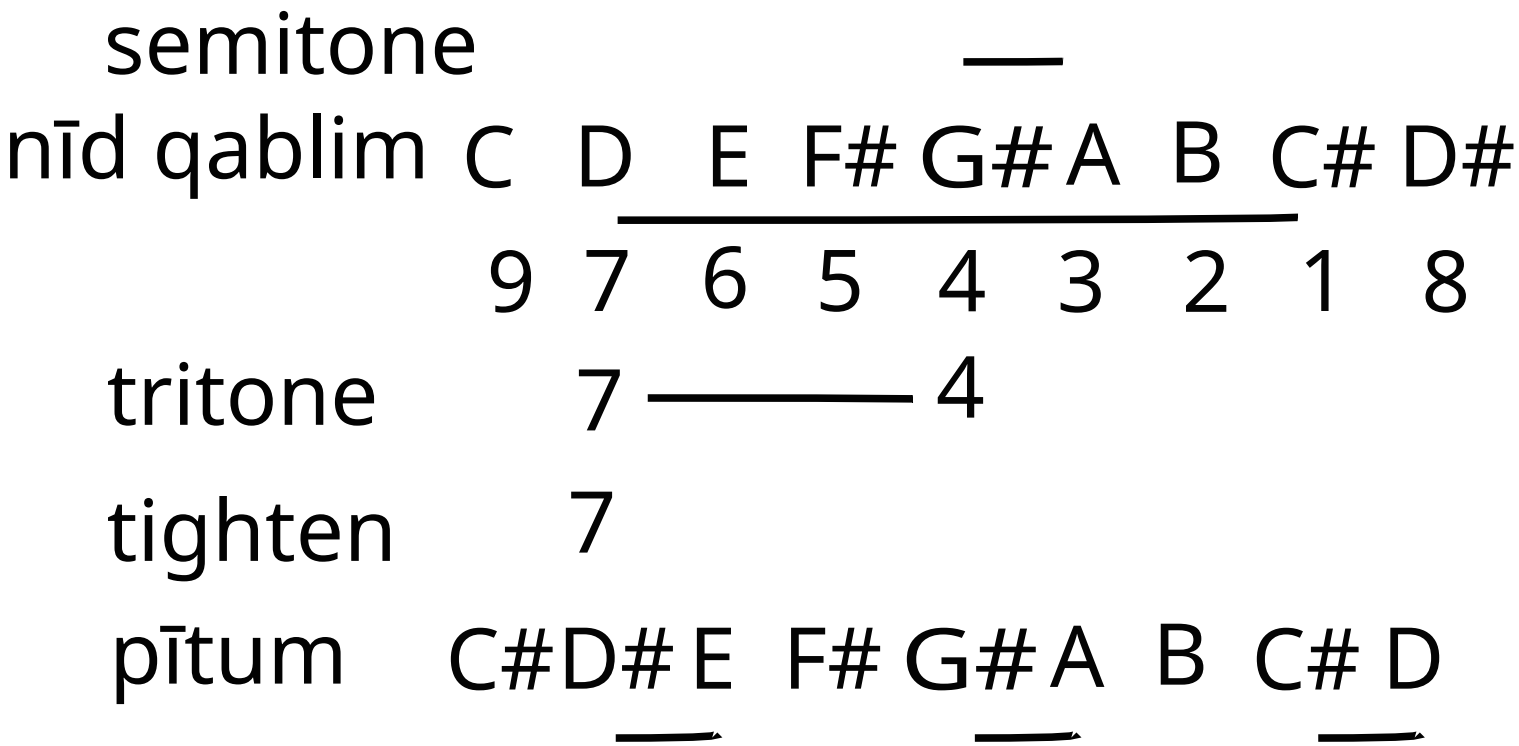
Tuning of a Babylonian harp 4

If the harp is nīd qablim

the 'unclear interval' between strings 7 and 4 is pītum

tighten string 7 (missing: lower 8, tighten 9)

the harp will be pītum



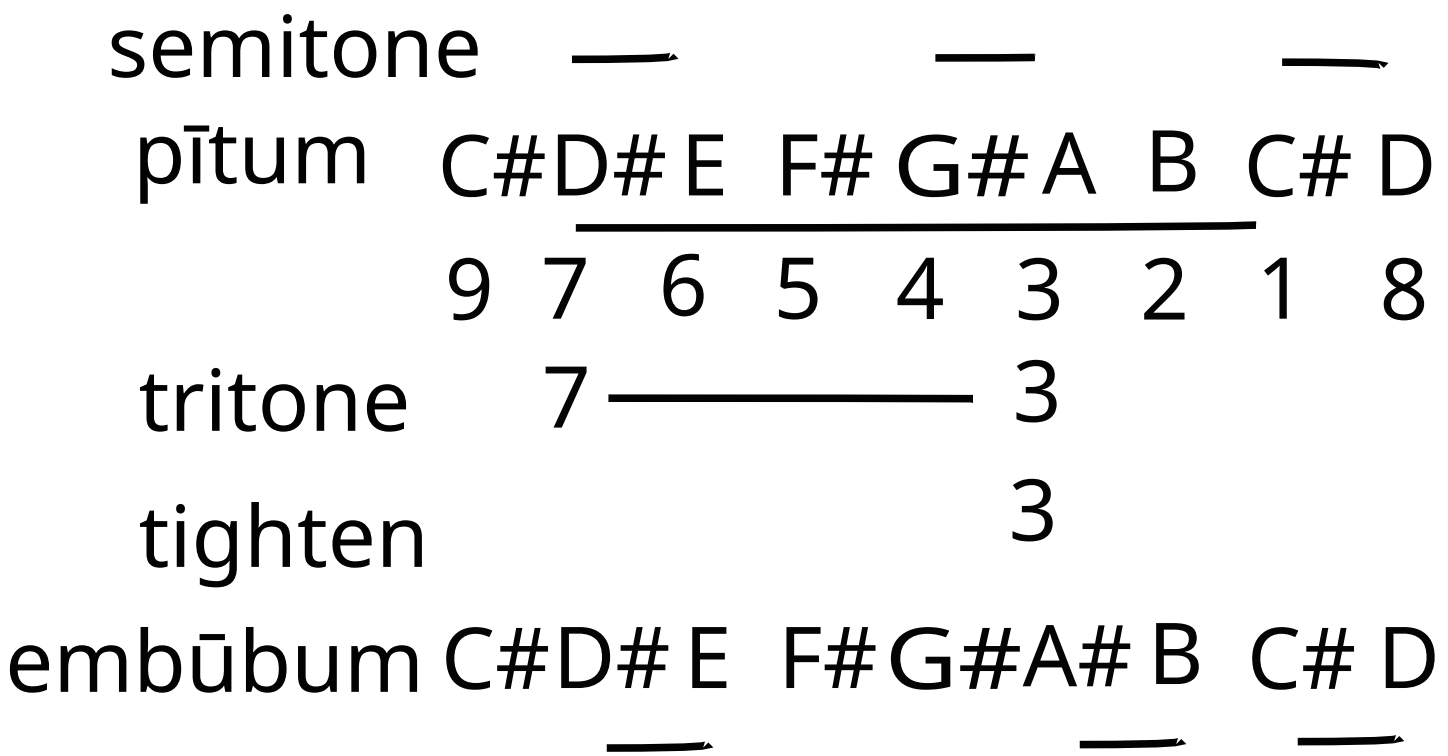
Tuning of a Babylonian harp 5

If the harp is pītum

the unclear interval between strings 3 and 7 is embūbum

tighten string 3

the harp will be embūbum



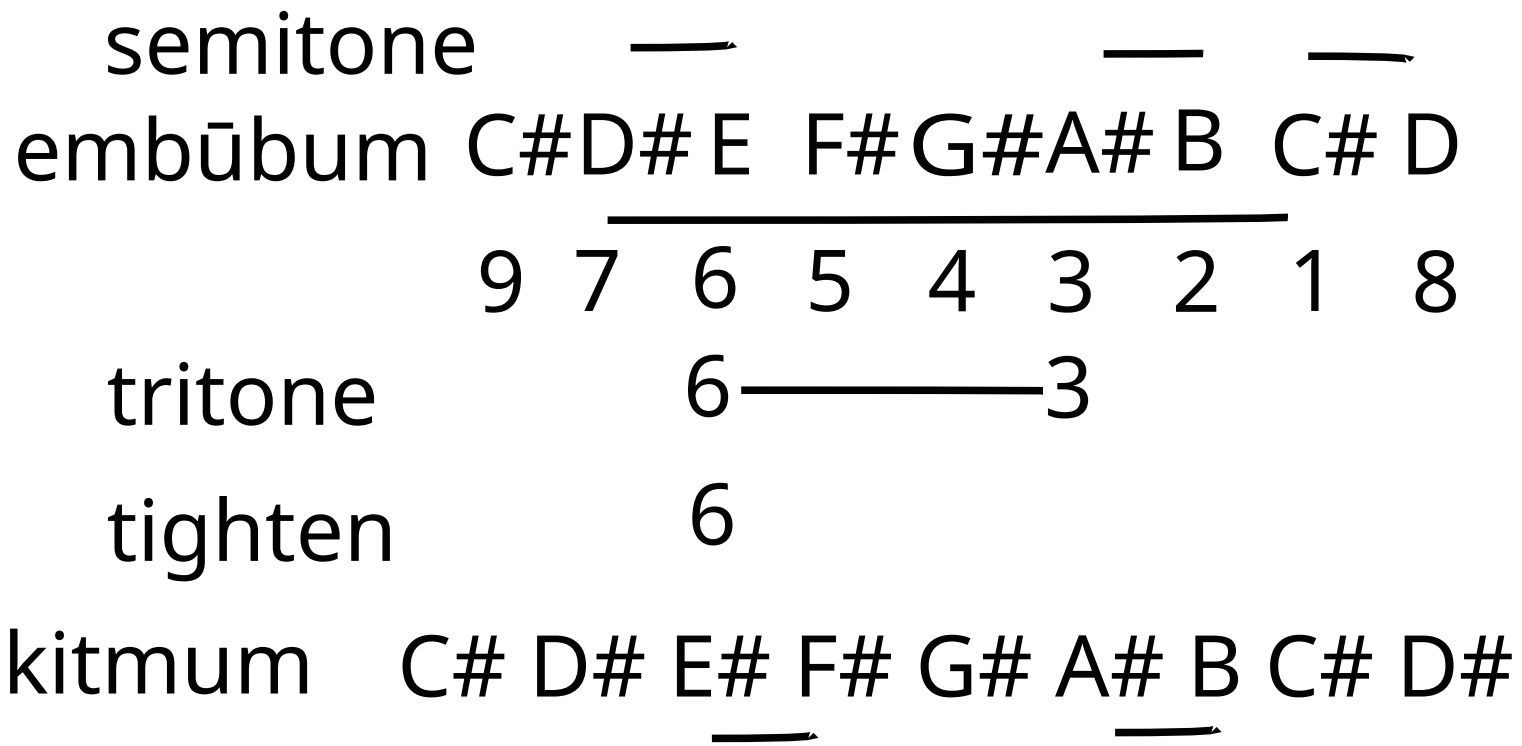
Tuning of a Babylonian harp 6

If the harp is embūbum

the ‘unclear interval’ between strings 6 and 3 is kitmum

tighten string 6 (missing: tighten 8)

then the harp will be kitmum



Tuning of a Babylonian harp 7

If the harp is kitmum

the 'unclear interval' between strings 2 and 6 is išartum

tighten strings 2 and 9

the harp will be išartum

